Rob Bickel · Managed Software Services

FREE ASSESSMENT

Software Estate Risk Scorecard

Twenty yes-or-no questions that show where the software your business depends on is most likely to fail you, and what to fix first.

How to use it

1. Answer for your most business-critical systems: billing, customer-facing apps, operations tools, and integrations.
2. Answer honestly. "Probably" counts as **No**.
3. Count your **No** answers per section and in total.
4. Use the scoring guide on page 3.

Takes about 10 minutes.

1 · Ownership & knowledge

Count of No: ___ / 5

1	Every critical system has a named person accountable for keeping it healthy.	☐ Yes	☐ No
2	At least two people (internal or a vendor) could safely change each critical system.	☐ Yes	☐ No
3	Nothing critical was built by someone who has since left without a documented handoff.	☐ Yes	☐ No
4	We have a current, written inventory of every application, integration, and script we rely on.	☐ Yes	☐ No
5	Each critical system has documentation a new engineer could use to deploy a fix.	☐ Yes	☐ No

2 · Operations & reliability

Count of No: ___ / 5

6	We'd know a critical system was down before a customer or employee told us.	☐ Yes	☐ No
7	Backups exist for every critical system, and we've tested a restore in the last 12 months.	☐ Yes	☐ No
8	Small change requests are completed in weeks, not months.	☐ Yes	☐ No
9	Deploying a change follows a repeatable, written process.	☐ Yes	☐ No
10	We know roughly what an hour of downtime costs for each critical system.	☐ Yes	☐ No

3 · Security & access

Count of No: ___ / 5

11	Domains, hosting, code repositories, and vendor accounts are owned by company logins, not individuals.	☐ Yes	☐ No
12	Credentials live in a shared password manager, not in inboxes, documents, or laptops.	☐ Yes	☐ No
13	Access is removed, and shared keys rotated, when someone leaves.	☐ Yes	☐ No
14	Software dependencies and frameworks are updated on a regular schedule.	☐ Yes	☐ No
15	We could answer a customer's or insurer's security questionnaire about these systems with confidence.	☐ Yes	☐ No

4 · Cost & complexity

Count of No: ___ / 5

16	We know the full annual cost of each system: licenses, hosting, and people's time.	☐ Yes	☐ No
17	We don't pay for multiple tools that do the same job.	☐ Yes	☐ No
18	Every subscription we pay for is actively used.	☐ Yes	☐ No
19	New tools, including AI experiments, are reviewed before teams adopt them.	☐ Yes	☐ No
20	Leadership reviews the software portfolio's cost and risk at least once a year.	☐ Yes	☐ No

Ownership	Operations	Security	Cost	**Total No answers**

SCORING GUIDE

What your score means

0–4

Under control

Your software has owners, visibility, and basic safeguards. Focus on keeping it that way with a quarterly portfolio review.

5–10

Exposed

Things work today, but you're relying on luck in places. One departure or outage could become expensive. Fix your weakest section first.

11–20

At risk

Critical systems lack an owner, visibility, or protection. Treat this as a business risk, not an IT task. Start with a full inventory.

Where to start, by section

1. **Ownership:** name an accountable owner for each critical system, and document anything only one person understands.
2. **Operations:** add uptime monitoring and alerts, then test one backup restore this month.
3. **Security:** move accounts to company ownership, adopt a password manager, and rotate keys former staff could reach.
4. **Cost:** review 12 months of software spend line by line and cancel what nobody uses.

A section with 3 or more No answers is usually where the next incident comes from.

Scored 5 or higher? Let's talk it through.

Send me your score and the systems you're worried about. I'll reply with the two or three changes that would reduce your risk the most. If you'd like ongoing help, I provide managed services for business software under one enterprise service agreement, with flexible scopes of work and monthly invoicing.

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